

winding road in the middle of the desert. No one's going to know it is there unless they come specifically looking for it. Or if someone guides them towards it. Getting website traffic is not easy. You will have to indulge in a lot of advertising and marketing to get it right.

Simple ways to do this is to invest in a good pay per click program, like Google AdWords for instance. But what happens when someone clicks on your ad and lands on your home page? Do they stay to browse or do they instantly close the tab? Closing the tab instantly leads to an increase in what internet marketers call a 'bounce rate'. The aim is not to just get people to your website, but for that visit to convert into a sale. Otherwise think about it - all you did was pay for people to come have a look see and then leave- the online equivalent of window shopping.

Design is key:

Have you ever landed on a website that had too much going on? Too many tabs cluttered together in the little space you see on the landing page. Graphics here, flashing tabs there, clashing colours, too much text - it's one big pile of chaos. How will your customer find what they are looking for if you have a website that looks like a 5-year old has put it together?

When it comes to shopping online, the experience is important for the end user. They need to be able to have a happy experience interacting with your website. Use a design that is clutter-free. You do not need to bring out the big guns as far as flashy graphics are concerned. The key here is to get your information across. Clear categories, easily visible tabs, and organised colour palettes that are soothing to the eye - stick with these and half the job is done.

Size does matter- especially for images and animations. Bigger the size, the longer your pages will take to load. Longer loading times automatically translate to irritated customers exiting the site even before you could dazzle them with your brilliance. How patient are you with slow sites? Upgrade your website from time-to-time to ensure that download times are as low as they can be. Faster loading sites could literally mean faster money making.

How compatible are we?

This is a sure shot question that every new business owner ought to be asking their design team. In today's day and age, everyone has multiple electronic devices at their disposal. And with the increasing number of